

Even with complete support for peripherals like mice and keyboard, the Chromebook Pixel didn't exactly get everyone reaching for their wallets. What it did though, was establish that the Chromebook was no longer a concept device and that similar but lower priced devices from OEMs were actually good for mainstream usage. In fact, our own experience with a Chromebook as a primary machine wasn't so bad. Read more on that here: <http://digit.in/ChrbmkMntb>.

What the Android integration means

One of the biggest markets that the Chrome OS lost out on, since its launch, was the smartphone market. But with the availability of Play Store on some Chromebooks, that seems to divert the development direction of both projects



Play Store support on Chromebooks makes them way more useful

towards a more unified approach (read more about that and the rumoured project Andromeda in the next Chapter). For actual devices, this would directly lead to beefier Chromebooks that can handle full-fledged apps running on a bigger platform than a hand-held device.

Perhaps this is the reason that the Google Chromebook documentation currently strongly recommends the inclusion of components like GPS, NFC, compass, accelerometer, a fingerprint

reader, and a barometer on Chromebooks. And it is best to assume that anything Google strongly recommends is headed to become mandatory soon enough for your own good. While this would not make sense for the current generation of Chromebooks, with increased support for Android apps that rely on all these sensors to work properly, we could be looking at a platform that not only relies on its software to prove its usefulness, but also brings a rich device ecosystem with it, much like the smartphone market right now.

Chromeboxes

Chromeboxes are mini-PCs from hardware manufacturers that run Google's Chrome OS as the operating system. While some of them come with a